

The UK Linguistics Olympiad 2019

Round 2



Solution and marking.

Scoring (max 29)

- **Q.1.1:** 1 for each correct answer, no half marks. (max 10)
- **Q.1.2:** 1 for each correct choice (a/b/c) (max 9)
 - 2 for each correct explanation, 1 with a single error.
- **Q.1.3:** 2 for each topic (listed below) covered correctly; 1 with one error. (max 10)

Q.1.1 a. afimadi	b. presidents	c. imeli
d. ature	e. baker	f. omukazisini
g. olengindi	h. language	i. isabatu
j. omukama		

Q.1.2.	(a), (b) or (c)?	explanation (ask for extra paper if necessary)
1. imulenzi	(b) boys	plural form with first and last vowels the same.
2. achosino	(a) school of fish	-sinV infix, as in <i>amelisini</i> vs <i>ameli</i> , <i>aturesine</i> vs <i>ature</i>
3. ukamamba	(c) banker	-ma- infix meaning 'professional X-er', as in baker, shoe-maker and farmer

Q.3. Describe what you have learned about the morphological structure of words in Afrihili.

A. Inflectional morphology:

- Plural formation: Final vowel replaces initial vowel of singular form.

B. Derivational morphology:

- Head of an organization: Final and initial vowel of root noun are reversed.
- Nouns of profession: Infix *-ma-* is inserted in penultimate position.
- Collective noun: Suffix *-sin-*+final vowel of root noun.
- Diminutive noun: Suffix *-nd-*+final vowel of root noun.

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Commentary

The following suffixes, infixes and alterations change the meaning of a word in Afrihili, where X is the original noun or its meaning:

- Final vowel replaces initial vowel → plural
- Final vowel and initial vowel are reversed → head of organization X
- Infix **-ma-** before final syllable → person who works with X
- Suffix **-le** or **-li** (depending on the preceding vowel) → place where X can be found
- Infix **-sin-** followed by replication of preceding vowel → a group of X